

ACTIVITY 23 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**Project Closure, Benefits Realisation and Lessons Learned**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Role Play	60 minutes	LO5	6 - Close the Project

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to close the project against the four ECO Process T10 enablers rather than against a feeling that the work is finished.

What learners produce

closure checklist, final report, lessons learned — submitted to artifacts/.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- The Project Management Templates pack (see the Activities folder)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the framework and worked example

Set-up

Groups of 3 to 4. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group; each group needs one laptop for the calculations.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Learning Pte Ltd is a training provider with 14,000 active learners. Its course registration portal is 9 years old. Registration takes a median of 11 minutes and 34% of attempts are abandoned. Learner communications consume 24 staff-hours per week across 3 administrators. 62% of learner traffic is mobile, against a portal that is not responsive. Legacy consent screens do not meet current PDPA requirements. The project modernises course registration and learner communications.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Define the closure criteria before closing anything. Create artifacts/23-closure-checklist.md. Enabler 1 requires you to state what "closed" means before you begin. These twenty items are the Contoso closure criteria.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
2	Verify scope before seeking acceptance. Control Quality comes first. Run the RTM closure check before anyone signs anything.	If a group finishes early, ask what changes at twice the scale or half the budget.
3	Obtain formal acceptance (enabler 2). Acceptance criteria must be stated per deliverable, and the accepting party must be the person who can actually judge it.	Debrief on what was conceded and why — the trade, not the outcome, is the learning.
4	Validate readiness for transition to operations (enabler	Watch for groups listing only the obvious. Ask

	3). Create artifacts/23-transition-plan.md. This is a go/no-go assessment, not a summary.	what they are deliberately leaving out, and why.
5	Write the final report. Create artifacts/23-final-report.md. Report all eight charter success criteria, including the miss.	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
6	Hand over the benefits (they are realised after you leave). Create artifacts/23-benefits-realisation.md.	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
7	Capture lessons learned that actually change something	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
8	Transfer the knowledge (People T7)	Insist on individual listing before pooling, or the loudest voice sets the whole list.
9	Release the team and close the human side	Debrief on what was conceded and why — the trade, not the outcome, is the learning.
10	Answer the exam-style scenarios	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
6 min	Brief the scenario, confirm the inputs and assign roles
22 min	Work the first half of the steps individually, then pool as a group
23 min	Complete the remaining steps and finalise the deliverable
9 min	Group share-back, facilitator debrief and exam-style linkage

Total: 60 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Close the project against the four ECO Process T10 enablers rather than against a feeling that the work is finished — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
2. Separate Validate Scope from Control Quality, and administrative closure from procurement closure — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
3. Report all eight charter success criteria honestly, including the one that was missed — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
4. You can state, without hesitation, that Control Quality verifies against specification internally and comes FIRST, and Validate Scope obtains customer acceptance and comes SECOND — can every member of your group defend it?
5. Where would project closure, benefits realisation and lessons learned have saved you time or money on a real project you have worked on?

What good looks like

- You can state, without hesitation, that Control Quality verifies against specification internally and comes FIRST, and Validate Scope obtains customer acceptance and comes SECOND.
- Your closure checklist includes procurement closure as a separate category from administrative closure, and you can say why procurement closes first.
- You reported SC-2 as NOT MET. If every criterion on your report is green, you edited rather than measured.
- You quantified the SC-2 consequence as a benefit shortfall of SGD 42,529 per year, rather than describing it as "slightly below target".

- Your final cost arithmetic reconciles: $271,000 + 197,400 + 10,500 = 478,900$, and you can explain each of the three components.
- You stated that the contingency reserve closed at ZERO and reported that as an exposure, not as a success.
- You attributed the SGD 43,520 improvement against forecast to specific causes, principally the CR-14 scope reduction, rather than claiming it as general good management.
- Every one of B1 to B4 has a named business owner who is not the project manager, and review dates that fall after the project has closed.